

Causes of Migration



RRHS 2019-2020



Migration

- The movement of people from place-to-place that redistributes the population.
- Included in the demographic equation



Migration is the long-term relocation of an individual, household, or larger group to a new locale outside the community of origin.

Voluntary Migration

- **Voluntary migration** has an element of choice based on some perceived opportunity.



People tend to move for economic opportunities, as well as family links. **Voluntary Migration** is based on push or pull factors – the “**push**” factors are those circumstances that encourage people to LEAVE their current location, while the “**pull**” factors are the perceived opportunities in the destination.



Catalyst of Migration

- Catalyst = thing that precipitates an event

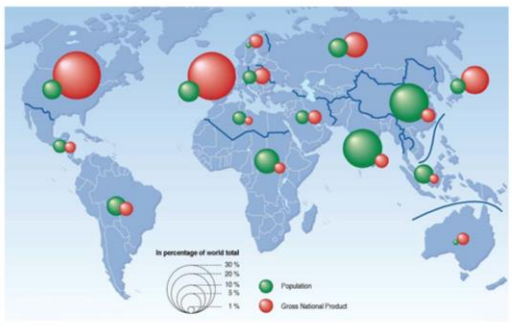
Catalyst means the “thing that precipitates and event” – or the start of a series of actions that results in change.

In the case of migration, the “catalyst” is some factor sets in motion a person moving from one place to another.



Push Factors

- Circumstances that make a person decide to **leave** place of origin
 - S.P.E.E.D.



International migrants **leaving** a country are known as “emigrants” (e=exit)

Impelled migration is the result of overwhelming push factors (the family feels they have no other choice)

Social Push factors include cultural issues, such as religious persecution or ethnic discrimination. For example, after the British partitioned India into Hindu and Islamic areas, millions of Muslims moved out of Hindu designate areas to Muslim West and East Pakistan (East Pakistan is now Bangladesh, and West Pakistan is Pakistan). Russian Jews facing discrimination in Europe moved to Israel. Mormons also moved westward across the US seeking to practice their faith in peace.

Political Push Factors include violence such as war, but most of the time the political factors are more forms of protest: opposition to taxes, oppressive governments, environmental restrictions, or any other law that would make a person living in that place want to move to a place with more favorable laws.

For example, a person may decide to move from inside the Austin city limits

and Austin ISD school district to just outside Taylor and the Taylor ISD because they feel the taxes for the two former taxing districts are too high, and they are much lower in Taylor (this is a hypothetical example, I do not know if the taxes in Taylor ISD are less, but property values are lower, and property taxes are based on a percentage of property value, so it is a reasonable assumption that taxes would be lower in Taylor ISD – yes, school taxes are based on property value, and property owners pay these taxes to fund schools).

Economic Push Factors have to do with the state of the economy in the place of origin – job loss/high unemployment is a major factor in the decision to move to a new location with better economic opportunities – ***economic factors are the most common reason people move.*** The graduated symbol map above shows places compares population (green circles) to GNP (red circles). The areas with large green circles and small red circles will have more emigrants.

Environmental push factors flooding, hurricanes, earthquakes, prolonged drought (such as the “Dust Bowl” in the 1920s U.S., fungal blight (such as the Irish Potato famine) may impel people to move – they feel that in order to regain stability, they have no choice but to move to a new location.

Demographic Push Factors include overcrowding. Overcrowding is a major reason for migration, particularly as a country is going through the rural-to-urban transition. In these cases, people are often pushed off the land they are on because commercial farmers buy it out, or in cases where primogeniture is still practiced.

Pull Factors

- Perceived opportunities at the destination.
 - Why a migrant would choose that destination.



A migrant crossing an international boundary into a new country is called an “immigrant” (i=into).

Social Pull Factors – good schools, active social scene, or family ties may be attractive reasons for someone to move to a new place.

Political Pull Factors - Favorable laws in one place may attract people to move there. “Favorable” is subjective, though. What is “favorable” to one group may be considered too restrictive or undesirable to another. For example, Austin has very lax rules regarding the homeless population – this may be very enticing to those who are homeless to move into the area.

Economic Pull Factors – Economic pull factors are the biggest reason why people move – the economic opportunities (better paying jobs, lower cost housing/cost of living, etc.) at the destination city are better than the ones in the place they are leaving.

Environmental Pull Factors - Environmental pull factors are where people move somewhere because they weather is nice, or because there is some

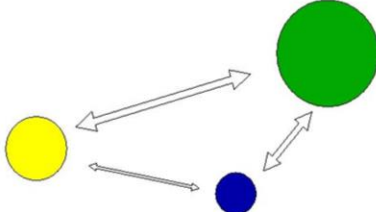
kind of outdoor recreational activity they would like to participate in – i.e., people who like mountains may be drawn to Colorado, people who like Mediterranean climates (warm summers, mild winters) may move to southern California. Many “snow birds” retirees move from the cold, snowy northeast to retirement communities in Arizona or Florida (where there is a combination of cultural and environmental pulls – people like to live with other people like them, and these communities cater to the wants of the retirees).

Demographic Pull Factors – The ratio of opportunities to population is low (meaning there are fewer people competing for the same jobs).

Where do they go?

- More likely a short distance than long distance
- The further they move, the more likely they are to move to a big city

Illustration of the Gravity Model



The shorter the distance between two objects, and the greater the mass of either (or both) objects, the greater the gravitational pull between the objects.

The “Gravity Model” illustrates the “pull” on migrants – The closer one place is to another, the greater the “gravitational pull” of that place on migrants, and there will be movement of people between the two places.

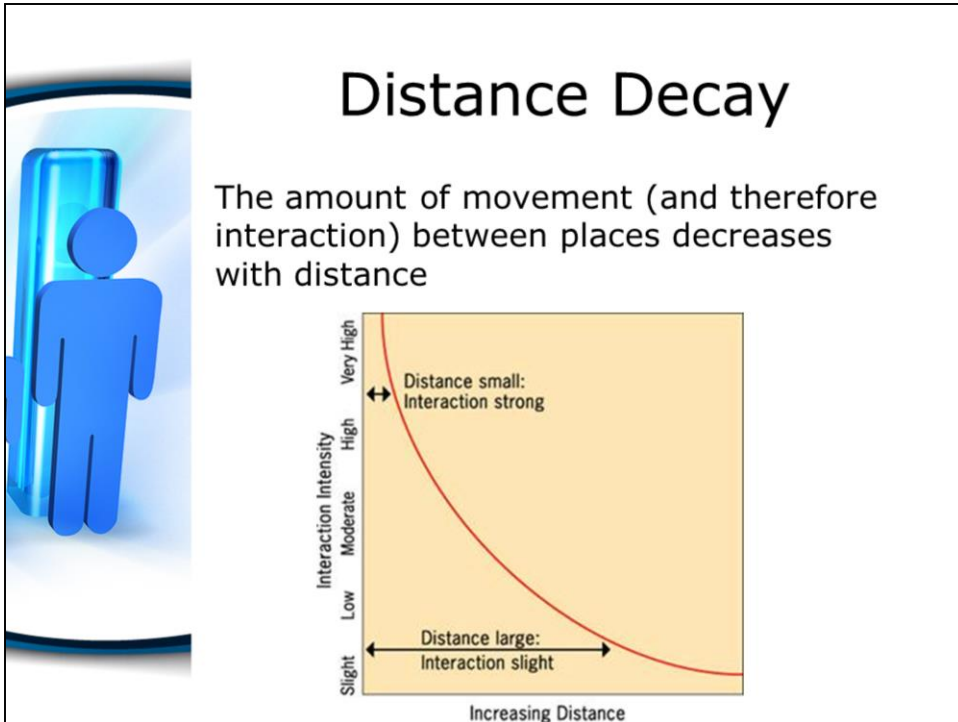
There is an **inverse relationship** between the number of migrants and the distance between cities -- **the number of migrants declines as the distance they must travel increases.**

The bigger the city, the more “pull” it will have and movement will occur between big places that are far apart. There is considerable flow of people between New York City and Los Angeles – these are both very large cities with high degrees of centrality, so they will “pull” people between them.

A person living in rural Pennsylvania is more likely to move to New York City than they are to move to Round Rock, Texas. New York has the greater “pull” plus it is closer. New York City is close proximity to Pennsylvania, and the size and number of opportunities of the city are attractive to potential migrants.

Someone living in Rockdale, Texas, is more likely to move to Round Rock. The

proximity of Rockdale to Round Rock is such that Round Rock's "gravity" reaches to Rockdale. There are more perceived opportunities in Round Rock, which is the closest "big" city to Rockdale.

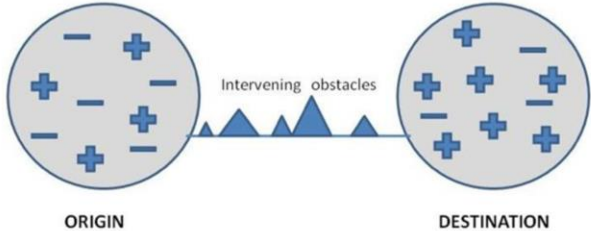


This model applies to migration as well. People are much more likely to move to a close-by city than to a distant, far away, unknown city.



Intervening Opportunities/Obstacles

- Migrant ends up in a place other than the original destination
 - Opportunity: something better comes up
 - Obstacle: something happens to block the move



ORIGIN

DESTINATION

An **intervening opportunity** is something that causes a person who is migrating to stop at a place between the place they left and the place they intended to go, such as a new job opportunity or lower cost housing somewhere else.

An **intervening Obstacle** is something that blocks the person from reaching their destination, such as a policy change restricting immigration.



Ravenstein's Laws of Migration

- Based on observations of migration in early 1900s
 - **See handout for a list of these observations**
 - Applies ONLY to voluntary migration
- Still (mostly) true today
- See the back for examples of how Ravenstein's laws apply to the U.S. today

Read the handout. You need to know what Ravenstein's observations were.

When do people migrate?

Table 6.1: Life Cycle and Migration Potential

Age	Family Membership	Migration
0	Family of origin	← All moves are tied to the family
12		
18	Single person	← Decision to leave home
25	Married couple	← Move on marriage
30		← Moves as a result of the expansion of the family and the need for more dwelling space
	Member of a rearing family	Long period of stability because of desire for educational continuity
	Decreasing family	← Children begin to leave home
50	Older couple	← Moves adjusting dwelling space to reduced needs
60		← Retirement migration
70	Single older person	← Widowhood

Note: Each arrow (←) represents a possible move.

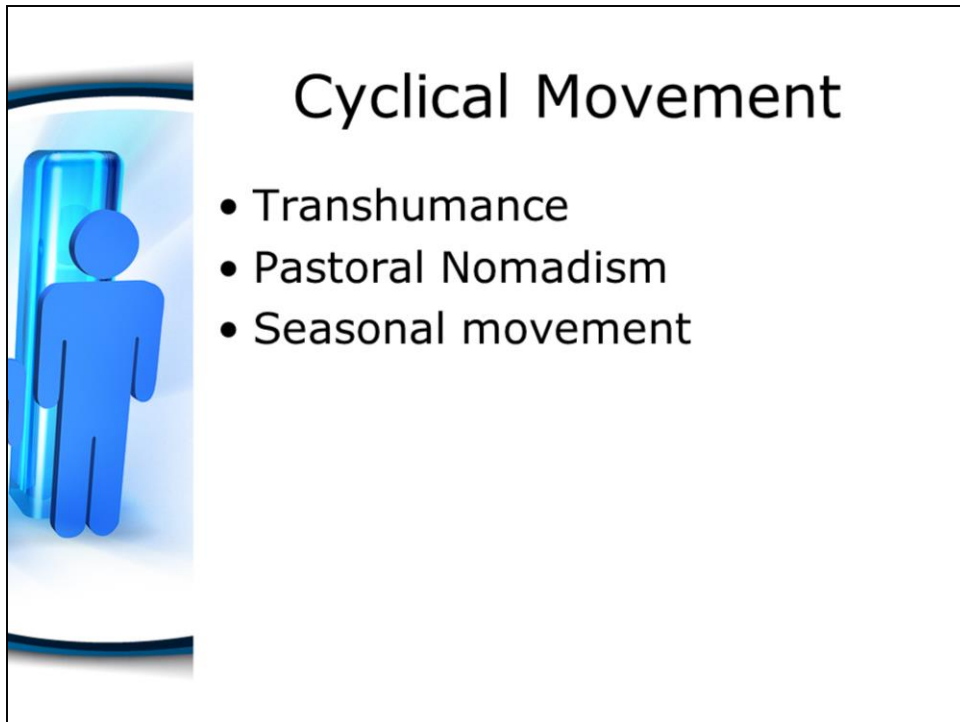
There are certain times in one's life when people are more likely to move. (See Chart above)

- Young, single adults are more mobile than families with children in school. The young adults make the move when they first leave their parents' home and before they have a family of their own.
- Young, single women are more likely to move within their same country (move to the cities to work in factories or retail)
- Young, single males are more likely to move internationally (across national boundaries)
- Families with children are unlikely to move internationally.



Types of Migration

- Cyclical movement
- Periodic movement
- Internal (intraregional) migration
- Interregional (internal or international)
- Rural-to-urban migration
- Trans-national (international) migration
- Chain Migration
- Step Migration
- Guest Workers



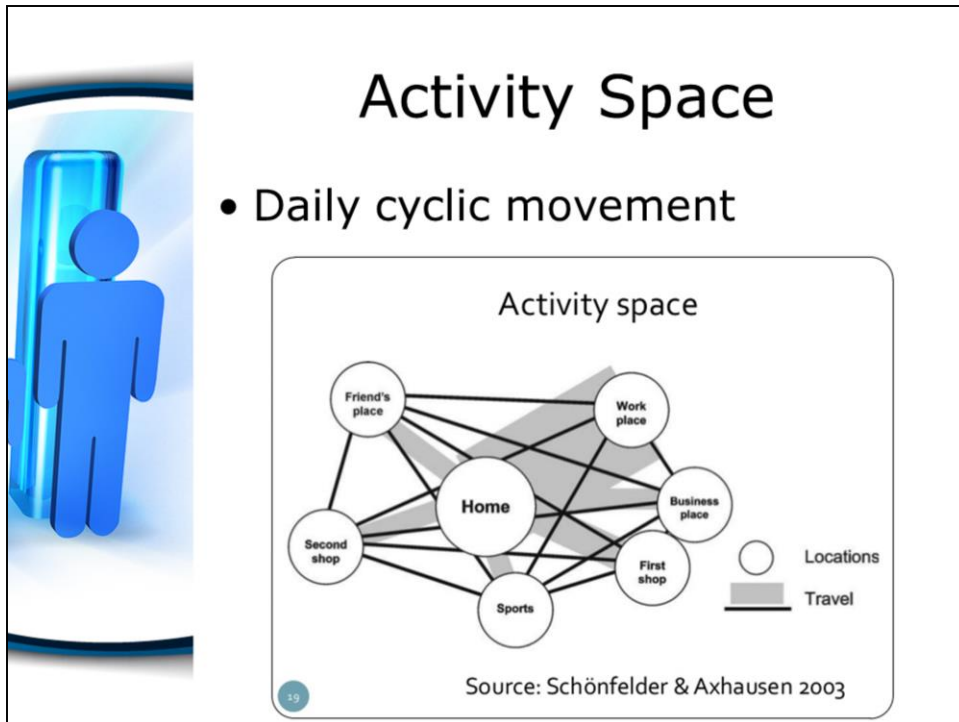
Types of migration where people migrate within a closed loop – the starting point is the same as the ending point, with stops along the way.

Transhumance is the movement of animals from one pasture to another during different parts of the year. This is common in mountainous regions as the herders/farmers/ranchers move their animals up or down the mountain depending on the weather (lower elevations in the winter when it snows/is significantly colder higher on the mountain; higher elevations in the summers when it is hotter down in the valley).

Pastoral Nomadism is purposeful and takes place along long-familiar routes – pastoral nomads (herders) move their animals long distances to water sources and pastures (more common in arid environments).

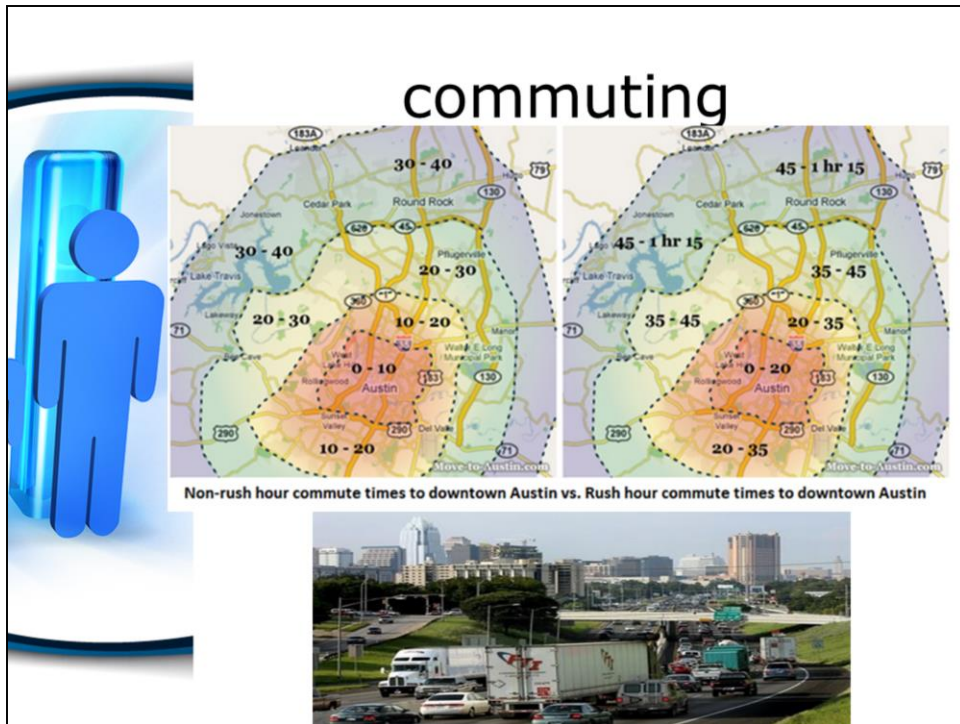
Seasonal Movement may look different depending on which part of the world you are in. Pastoral Nomadism is associated with subsistence agriculture. Agricultural workers, however, may move seasonally to follow the jobs in commercial agriculture (sold for profit rather than own consumption). Commercial agriculture is very common in MDCs. Finally, another group that tends to move with the season are the “snow birds” – retirees who live in one

part of the country during the winter months (such as Southern Florida) and another part of the country during the summer months (such as the Northeast). They move seasonally between homes to where the weather is most favorable during that season.



This is the **daily** cyclical movement of each person. It is centered around the home, and includes places like school/work, the grocery store/gas station/other stores, friends' homes, etc.

Availability of transportation will have a significant impact on the size of one's activity space. For example, a young student who must walk or ride his bike everywhere he goes will have a much smaller activity space than an adult who owns a car and commutes to work in another city.



Traveling between one's home and place of employment on a regular basis –
Transportation networks are key to commuting movement

The two maps above show the average amount of time it takes to travel each day for commuters – those traveling during “rush hour” (the peak travel time) will spend significantly more time in their car each day than those who are able to commute during off-peak times. The relative distance between Downtown Austin and the surrounding communities increases or decreases depending on the time of day.

Commuting is part of a person's activity space and is a cyclical movement.



Periodic Movement

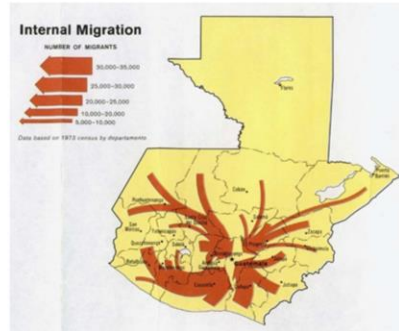
- Movement that occurs every so often, but does not necessarily involve returning to the same places
 - College/education
 - Military service
 - Migrant labor

Periodic movement means moves that are long-term, but are not considered permanent.

(internal) Intra regional Migration



- Migration within the same geographic region (can be applied at different scales)
 - New house within the same city
 - New city within the same state
 - New state within the same country



The prefix “intra” means “within”



Interregional Migration

- Movement between two distinctive geographic regions
 - May be internal (large countries)
 - Often international (between world regions)

The prefix “inter” means “across” or “between” – the regions must be distinctively different to be considered interregional migration

Examples:

- Internal interregional migration: Moving between two very distinctive regions of the same country, such as someone moving from Ohio to Phoenix (moving from the Midwest to the Southwest)
- International Interregional migration: Moving from North Africa to Europe



Rural-to-Urban

- Moving from rural (often agricultural-based) regions to urban (city) areas.



The largest movement of people within the past 100 years has been the rural-to-urban migration.

- Occurs as a part of economic development (technology in agriculture means fewer people are needed to tend to the crops). Those not farming seek other economic opportunities
- consolidation of small family farms into large commercial farms results in displacement of people from the farm land. The displaced people move to the city.
- The shift from “more rural” to “more urban” occurs during stage 3 of the DTM.

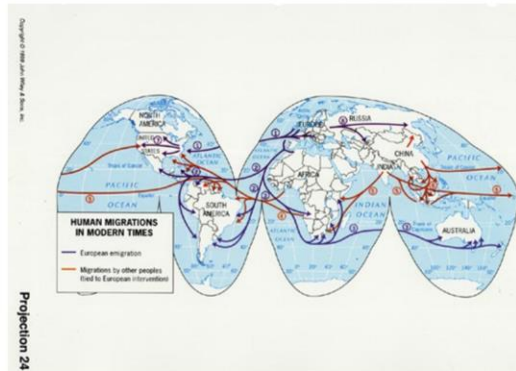


The largest movement of people in human history rural-to-urban migration currently underway in China. It is estimated that by 2035 70% of China's population will live in cities.



Trans-national migration

- International migration
 - Moving from one country to another.





Chain Migration

- When migrants move along kinship links.
- There must be some reverse communication (people who have already moved encourage more people to follow them)
 - Remittances common along with this communication
- Results in ethnic neighborhoods/communities



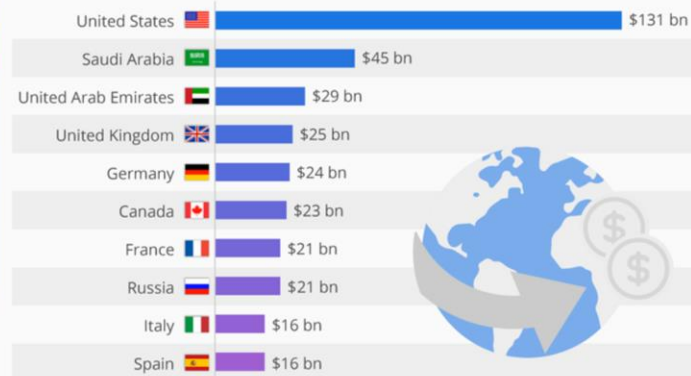

This is a series of migrations within a family or defined group of people. It often begins with one family member who then sends money to bring other family members over to the new location. For example, an immigrant moves to Austin. They enjoy Austin and believe there is economic opportunity. They then write home to their family members encouraging them to move or send them money for the move. Their family members then move to the same area. This would be chain migration. Due to chain migration you see the spatial phenomena known as “ethnic neighborhoods” develop such as Chinatown (found in many cities around the world) and Little Italy in NYC.

Remittances are payments/money sent by migrants back to family/friends in their home countries. These payments are often very important to the local economies of the native country. This money **leaves** the country where it is earned by the migrant as wages and is spent and used in the economy of their home country.

Remittances

Which Country Sends The Most Remittances?

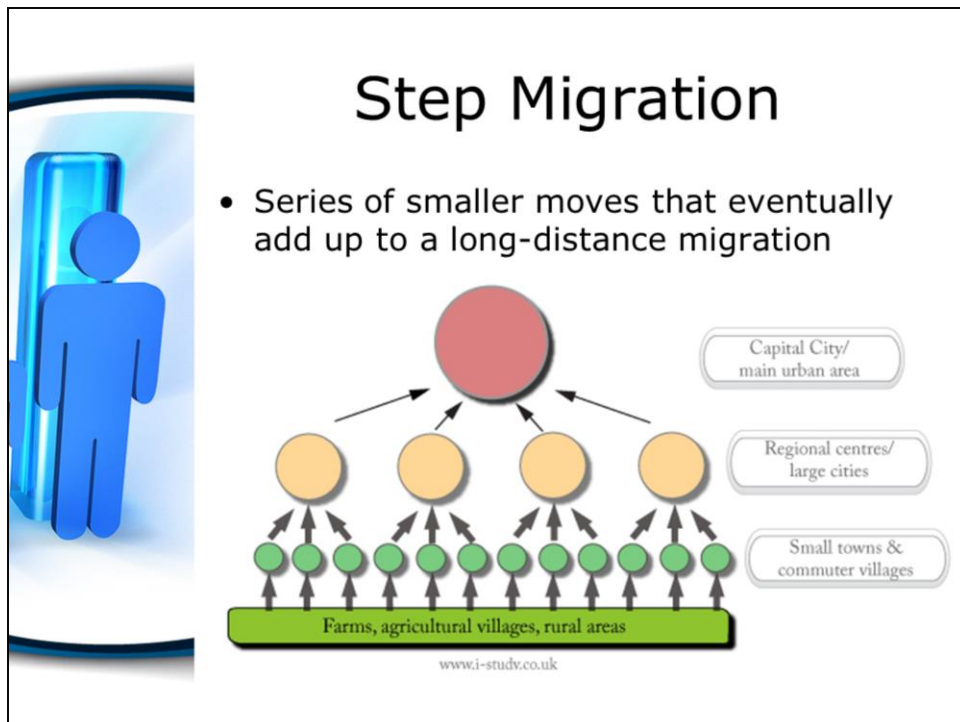
The top 10 remittance-sending countries in 2014 (billion U.S. dollars)



Source: World Bank

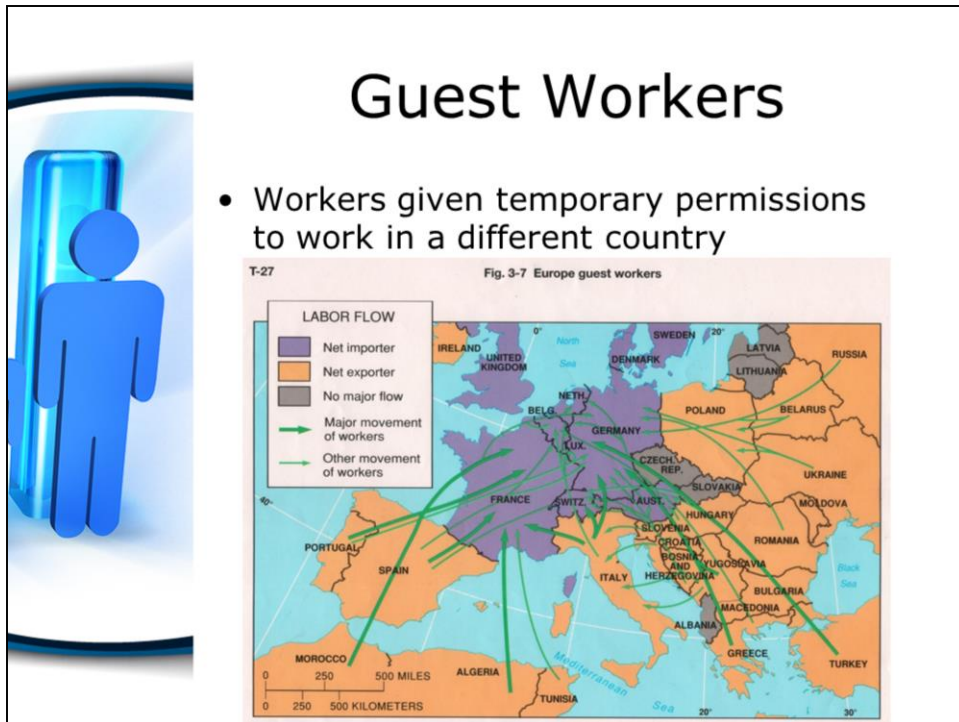
Forbes statista

The chart above shows the countries from which remittances are sent to other countries.



A rural resident decides to move to a new location – they move to the small town that is nearby. Then, a few years later, they decide to move again and move to the small city located about an hour away. Finally, a few years after that, the migrant decides to go look for work in a major urban area that is many hundreds of miles away from his starting point back on the farm.

For example, if this were to occur in 1950s Texas – a person from Dime Box (tiny little rural community between here and Houston) may first move to Lexington (a small rural community, but larger than Dime Box). Then they may move to Giddings (a town), then Elgin (a small city), and finally Austin. They eventually make their way into the largest city in the area, but it took a number of years and several *steps* along the way.



Guest workers are international migrants who are granted temporary permissions to work in a country other than their home country. The time span may range from a few months to decades. These workers often have restrictions placed on where they can live and work (such as they must remain employed by the company that sponsored them to enter the country).

This map shows guest workers who emigrate primarily from Eastern European and North Africa to work in the wealthier, more developed countries of Western Europe.

Guest workers came to Germany from Turkey in the 50's and 60's. The German government never granted them citizenship or tried to integrate them into German society. The migration to Germany is a result of government agreements.

You see migration to France from the former French colonies.

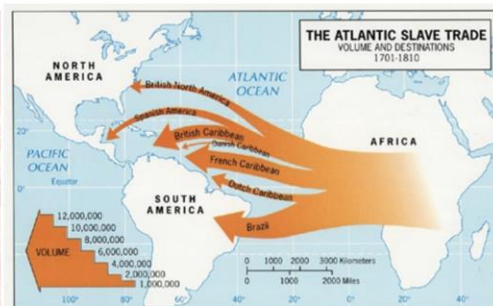
There is a trend of workers coming from former colonies.

Distinctive migration routes have emerged among importing and exporting countries.

Many workers migrated from South Asia to SW Asia looking for employment in the oil fields (industry dominated by men. This will also alter the population pyramid for these countries. Many more male to female ration in the bearing bracket ages).

Forced Migration

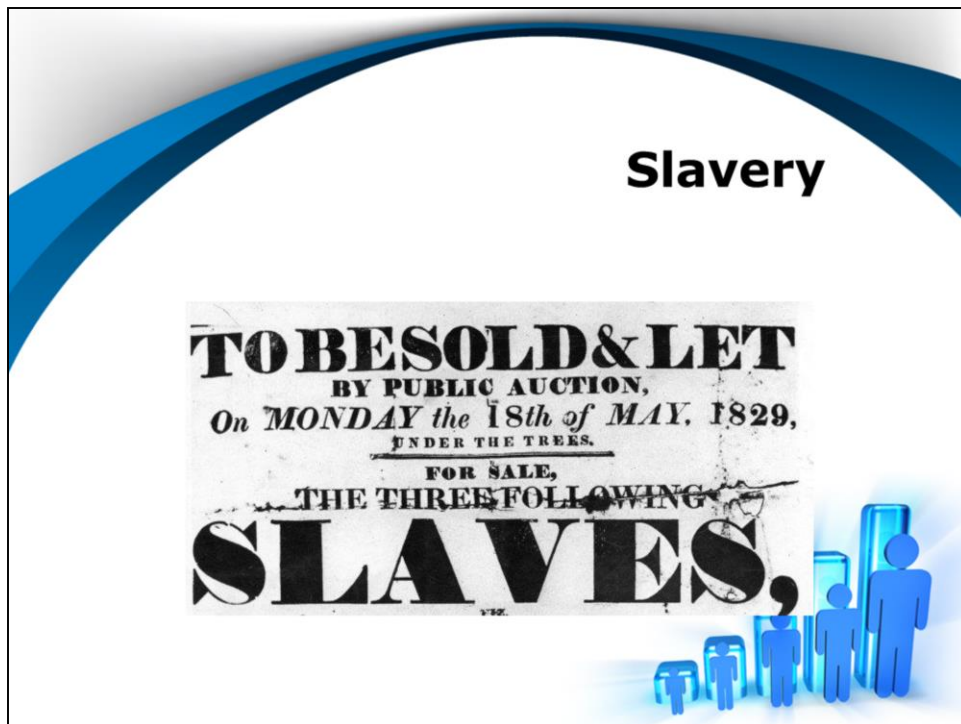
- The person moving has no choice in the matter



Push and Pull factors apply to ONLY voluntary migration. In forced migration, the element of choice has been removed. The person either moves as they are told or they face imprisonment or death.

The Trail of Tears (Indian Removal Act that moved Native Americans out of the American South into reservations in Oklahoma) and the Atlantic Slave Trade are two examples of forced migration.

People who are forced to migrate for fear of their life are called refugees.



Slavery is any system in which principles of property law are applied to people, allowing individuals to own, buy and sell other individuals, as a recognized form of property. A slave is unable to leave such an arrangement (often under fear of violence) and works without pay.

Slavery still exists in the world today, though it is not legal – slave laborers are held against their will and forced to work (often in very difficult conditions) by threats of being killed, beaten, or their families attacked. Modern-day slavery is often referred to as human trafficking.



A refugee according to the UNHCR (United Nations High Commission on Refugees) is “a person who has a well founded fear of being persecuted for reasons of race, religion, nationality, membership in a particular social group or political opinion”.

An individual classification as a refugee is important because refugees are eligible for assistance from the government of the host country. Countries that signed the 1951 Geneva Convention relating to the status of refugees are bound to not return these newcomers to places where they could be persecuted or harmed.

International refugees move **between** countries.

Most refugees qualify for refugee status due to war or social factors such as religious persecution, ethnic cleansing (forced removal of a group from a location by a more powerful group) or genocide (systemic extermination (murder) of a group of people by a more powerful group, such as what occurred against the Jewish people in Nazi-controlled Germany during what is now known as the Holocaust).

To qualify as an environmental refugee, the environmental disaster would have to completely devastate the entire country so that the only choice is to leave the country – i.e., an earthquake completely destroys the infrastructure of a smaller country and

the government is unable to respond quickly or effectively, which would put the citizens at risk of imminent death or hardship if they remained in the country.

Refugees can be permanent or temporary. The goal for most refugees is to eventually “repatriate” (return them to their homeland) once the violence subsides or the conditions improve.

Internally Displaced Persons

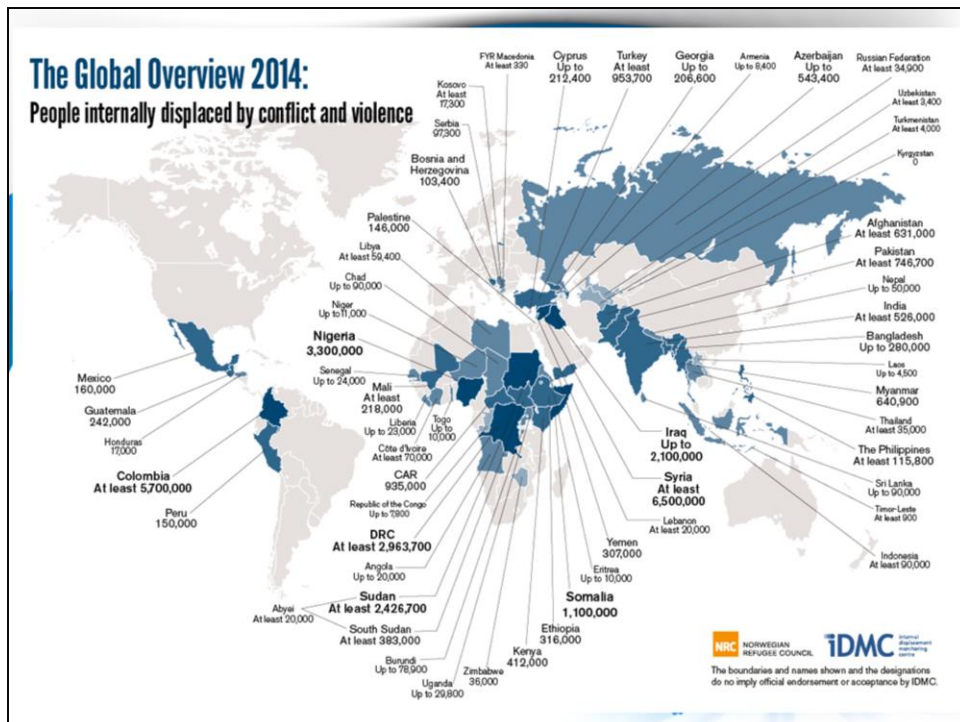
- Forced migration
- relocate to a new location within the same country
- Do NOT have refugee status



People displaced within their own countries.

War and environmental disasters can cause millions of people to flee their homes, but if they do not cross international borders, they are not considered refugees.

An example of internally displaced persons occurred in the United States in 2005 – Hurricane Katrina set off a series of environmental disasters that flooded large portions of New Orleans, LA, and surrounding cities. The hurricane itself caused massive damage, but the secondary technological failures (levee and dam breaks) that followed resulted in the displacement of over a million people. This displacement, however, did not force people into other countries, so would those displaced are considered to be “internally displaced” rather than refugees.



The map above shows the number of people displaced within their own countries as a result of conflict and violence.

Asylum Seekers

- Someone seeking legal protections from another government
 - May qualify as refugee, but status upon arrival and application is undetermined.



Asylum seekers are people who arrive in a country and seek legal protections from the government of that country. They are asking permission to stay in the new country and not be returned to their home country for fear of punishment or death.

Political asylum seekers are individuals who often have fled their country after speaking out against the leaders (which is not protected in many countries the way it is here) and are at risk of imprisonment because of their actions. During the Cold War, many Russians and East Germans who “defected” (abandon one’s country or cause in favor of an opposing one) to the United States or Western European countries sought asylum status as returning to their home country after such a move could result in imprisonment or execution.

People who have fled their country who have not yet been granted refugee status are considered asylum seekers until they are granted that status.